

Jalsa, we are not just launching a watch, we are presenting a cultural artefact.”

A tribute to 225 years of the Hawa Mahal, the watch's marble dial is painted in natural gemstone pigments. The case is hewn from 18-karat rose gold, set with luminous red agate. Within, a flying tourbillon movement—engineered in-house by Titan—comprises 144 components and 14 jewels, anchored by bridges inlaid with the same crimson stone.

Design elements include a sapphire crystal exhibition caseback and a sapphire magnifier integrated into the minute hand's counterpoise.

“Jalsa is more than design—it is conviction, legacy, and artistry woven into one extraordinary time-piece,” says Revathi Kant, Titan's chief design officer.

While Titan's foray is gaining attention, it's not the only Indian brand attempting to redefine horology. Over the past decade, a number of boutique watchmakers—often working with little historical support—have sought to embed Indian history, design, and innovation into an industry that is largely European.

One of the earliest to take that leap was Gaurav Mehta, a former reinsurance professional and lifelong watch collector. In 2013, he founded the Jaipur Watch Company (JWC), the country's

first “bridge-to-luxury” boutique watch brand. “When we launched, the most expensive Indian watches were around ₹15,000,” says Mehta. “My first model cost ₹23,000. The retailers couldn't understand why anyone would pay that much for an Indian brand.”

It took him two years to sell his first 300 watches. Today, JWC manufactures 3,500 watches annually and reports monthly revenues of around ₹1.5 crore. “We're aiming for ₹25 crore this year,” says Mehta, “which will require

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Bangalore Watch Company draws inspiration from contemporary India with prices between ₹1 lakh and ₹2.5 lakh